NDA SSB Personal Interview: 100 Questions with Sample Answers

The personal interview in the NDA Services Selection Board (SSB) process is designed to understand your personality, background, thought process, confidence, communication skills, awareness and suitability for a career as an officer in the Indian Armed Forces.

Below are **100 commonly asked and practice-oriented SSB personal interview questions, divided into 4 sets of 25 questions each, with sample answers.**

Before you start: Important advice

SSB assessors are not looking for memorised answers. They want to understand the real person behind the answers.

- Be honest about your strengths and weaknesses.
- Avoid exaggerating your achievements.
- Give practical examples from your life.
- Be confident but not overconfident.
- Keep your answers clear, logical and natural.

The sample answers below are illustrative. Replace personal details with your actual experiences.

SET 1: Personal Background, Family and Education (25 Questions)

These questions help the interviewing officer understand your background, upbringing, personality and academic journey.

1. Tell me something about yourself.

Sample answer:

"Good morning, Sir. My name is [Your Name]. I belong to [City/State]. I have completed/am pursuing Class 12 from [School Name]. I enjoy [hobbies], and I am particularly interested in sports, learning new things and developing my personality. I consider myself responsible, disciplined and willing to learn from my mistakes. My ambition is to serve the nation as an officer in the Indian Armed Forces."

2. Tell me about your family.

Sample answer:

"Sir, we are a family of [number] members. My father is a [profession], and my mother is a [profession/homemaker]. I have [number] siblings who are studying/working. My family has taught me the importance of discipline, honesty, respect and responsibility. We support each other and believe in working hard towards our goals."

3. What is your father's profession, and what have you learned from him?

Sample answer:

"My father works as a [profession]. I have learned consistency, responsibility and dedication from him. One thing I particularly admire is his commitment towards his work and family."

4. What is your mother's role in your life?

Sample answer:

"My mother has played an important role in my upbringing. She has taught me patience, compassion and the importance of managing responsibilities. I have also learned to remain calm and handle difficult situations from her."

5. Who are you closer to, your mother or your father?

Sample answer:

"I share a good relationship with both. I approach my father for guidance on certain practical decisions, while I often discuss personal matters with my mother. However, I am comfortable sharing my thoughts with both of them."

6. What are your responsibilities at home?

Sample answer:

"I help with household activities such as [mention actual activities]. I also take responsibility for managing my daily schedule and completing my personal work independently. These activities have helped me become more responsible."

7. What is your relationship with your siblings?

Sample answer:

"I share a friendly relationship with my siblings. We help each other with studies and personal matters. Sometimes we disagree, but we discuss our differences and resolve them."

8. What is your favourite subject and why?

Sample answer:

"My favourite subject is [Mathematics/Physics/English/etc.]. I enjoy it because it improves my analytical thinking and helps me understand concepts logically. I also find satisfaction in solving challenging problems."

9. Which subject do you dislike?

Sample answer:

"I find [Subject] relatively challenging compared to other subjects. However, I understand its importance and work on improving my understanding through regular practice."

10. What was your percentage in Class 10 and Class 12?

Sample answer:

"I scored [percentage]% in Class 10 and [percentage]% in Class 12. My performance was particularly good in [subjects]. I also identified areas where I could improve, and I worked on them."

11. Why did you choose your particular stream?

Sample answer:

"I chose the [Science/Commerce/Arts] stream because of my interest in the subjects and their relevance to my future goals. I wanted to develop a strong academic foundation while preparing for my career."

12. Who was your favourite teacher and why?

Sample answer:

"My favourite teacher was my [subject] teacher. Apart from teaching the subject effectively, the teacher encouraged students to ask questions, think independently and participate in activities."

13. Have you ever been punished at school?

Sample answer:

"Yes, Sir. Once I was [explain the actual incident]. I understood that I had made a mistake and accepted the consequences. Since then, I have tried to be more careful about following rules and managing my responsibilities."

14. Were you a good student?

Sample answer:

"I would describe myself as a reasonably good student. I maintained consistency in my studies and participated in activities whenever possible. I also had areas that required improvement, which I worked on gradually."

15. What extracurricular activities did you participate in?

Sample answer:

"I participated in [sports, debates, cultural events, quizzes, etc.]. These activities helped me improve my teamwork, communication and confidence."

16. Have you ever held a leadership position?

Sample answer:

"Yes, Sir. I was [class monitor/team captain/event coordinator, if applicable]. My responsibility was to coordinate activities, communicate with team members and ensure that assigned work was completed."

If you have never held a formal position, mention an actual situation where you took responsibility.

17. What are your hobbies?

Sample answer:

"My hobbies include [reading, playing cricket, running, drawing, etc.]. I enjoy these activities because they help me remain active, develop concentration and use my free time productively."

Important: Be prepared for detailed questions about every hobby you mention.

18. How do you spend your free time?

Sample answer:

"I usually spend my free time playing sports, reading, exercising or learning something new. I also spend time with my family and friends."

19. Who is your best friend? Describe him/her.

Sample answer:

"My best friend is [Name]. We have known each other for [duration]. I appreciate his/her honesty, helpful nature and positive attitude. We motivate each other in academics and extracurricular activities."

20. What qualities do you like in your friends?

Sample answer:

"I appreciate honesty, reliability, a positive attitude and a willingness to help others. I also value friends who can give constructive feedback rather than simply agreeing with everything I say."

21. What are your three strengths?

Sample answer:

"My three strengths are consistency, willingness to learn and responsibility. I try to complete my assigned work on time, accept feedback and improve wherever necessary."

22. What are your weaknesses?

Sample answer:

"Sometimes I spend more time than necessary analysing a decision. I am working on improving this by setting time limits, identifying priorities and making decisions based on available information."

23. What is your biggest achievement so far?

Sample answer:

"My biggest achievement so far has been [actual achievement]. I am proud of it because it required consistent effort, discipline and overcoming challenges."

24. What is your biggest failure?

Sample answer:

"One failure I experienced was [actual incident]. Initially, I was disappointed, but I analysed what went wrong and identified the areas that needed improvement. It taught me that failure should be treated as feedback for future efforts."

25. How would your friends describe you?

Sample answer:

"My friends would probably describe me as approachable, dependable and helpful. They may also say that I sometimes take time to make decisions, which is something I am working to improve."

SET 2: Personality, Behaviour, Leadership and Situational Questions (25 Questions)

These questions evaluate your practical thinking, emotional maturity, decision-making, leadership potential and interpersonal skills.

26. Why do you want to join the Indian Armed Forces?

Sample answer:

"Sir, I want to join the Indian Armed Forces because I am attracted to the combination of responsibility, leadership, discipline and service to the nation. I want a career that challenges me physically and mentally while giving me an opportunity to lead people and contribute meaningfully to the country."

27. Why do you want to become an officer and not join as a soldier?

Sample answer:

"Sir, I am interested in the responsibilities associated with officership, particularly planning, decision-making, leading teams and taking responsibility for outcomes. I believe the officer's role matches my interests and long-term career aspirations."

28. What does leadership mean to you?

Sample answer:

"Leadership means taking responsibility, setting an example, guiding people towards a common objective and ensuring that everyone contributes effectively. A good leader also listens to the team and accepts responsibility for mistakes."

29. Are you a leader or a follower?

Sample answer:

"I believe I can perform both roles depending on the situation. When responsibility is assigned to me, I try to lead effectively. When someone else has greater experience or authority, I am comfortable following instructions and contributing to the team's objective."

30. What would you do if your team members disagreed with your decision?

Sample answer:

"I would first listen to their opinions and understand their concerns. If their suggestions improve the decision, I would incorporate them. If my decision remains appropriate, I would explain the reasoning and move forward while keeping the team motivated."

31. How do you handle pressure?

Sample answer:

"I try to remain calm, identify the most important tasks and divide the problem into manageable steps. I focus on what I can control instead of becoming overwhelmed by the situation."

32. What would you do if you failed an examination?

Sample answer:

"I would analyse my preparation, identify the subjects or topics where I performed poorly and develop a better study strategy. I would treat the result as feedback and work towards improving my performance."

33. What would you do if your friend cheated in an examination?

Sample answer:

"I would explain to my friend that cheating is unethical and can have serious consequences. I would encourage him to work honestly. If required, I would follow the examination rules and report the incident through the appropriate channel."

34. What would you do if you saw someone being bullied?

Sample answer:

"I would intervene appropriately, ensuring that the situation does not become more dangerous. I would support the person being bullied and inform the relevant authority if necessary."

35. Suppose your senior gives you an order that you believe is incorrect. What would you do?

Sample answer:

"I would respectfully clarify the instruction and communicate my concerns through the proper channel. I would ensure that I understand the objective and act according to lawful orders and established procedures."

36. How would you motivate a demotivated team?

Sample answer:

"I would first understand why the team has lost motivation. I would discuss the challenges, set achievable short-term goals and encourage everyone to contribute. I would also recognise genuine efforts and lead by example."

37. What is more important: intelligence or hard work?

Sample answer:

"Both are important. Intelligence helps us understand problems and identify solutions, while hard work helps us execute those solutions consistently. I believe combining both produces better results."

38. What is your biggest fear?

Sample answer:

"My biggest concern is not making proper use of opportunities and falling short of my responsibilities. I try to address this by setting goals, maintaining discipline and continuously improving myself."

39. Are you an introvert or an extrovert?

Sample answer:

"I would describe myself as an ambivert. I enjoy interacting with people and participating in group activities, but I also value time spent independently learning and reflecting."

40. How do you react when someone criticises you?

Sample answer:

"I try to understand whether the criticism is constructive. If it highlights a genuine mistake, I accept it and work on improving. I do not believe criticism should automatically be taken personally."

41. What would you do if two team members started fighting?

Sample answer:

"I would try to calm the situation, separate the individuals if necessary and understand both sides. I would encourage them to resolve the disagreement professionally and involve the appropriate authority if the situation escalated."

42. Would you choose friendship over duty?

Sample answer:

"I value friendships, but I would not compromise my responsibilities or ethical principles for personal relationships. I would try to handle the situation fairly and professionally."

43. What motivates you?

Sample answer:

"My motivation comes from setting meaningful goals, making progress and taking responsibility for my actions. I also feel motivated when I see the results of consistent effort."

44. How do you manage your time?

Sample answer:

"I prioritise tasks according to their importance and deadlines. I prepare a daily schedule, allocate time for studies, physical activities and rest, and review my progress regularly."

45. What would you do if you had to make an important decision with limited information?

Sample answer:

"I would identify the objective, gather the most relevant available information, evaluate possible consequences and make a timely decision. I would also remain prepared to modify my decision if new information became available."

46. What is the difference between confidence and overconfidence?

Sample answer:

"Confidence means believing in one's abilities while understanding limitations. Overconfidence means overestimating one's abilities and ignoring risks or advice. Confidence encourages preparation, whereas overconfidence can lead to careless decisions."

47. How would you handle a situation where you are responsible for a mistake made by your team?

Sample answer:

"I would take responsibility for my role in the situation, understand what went wrong and work towards correcting the mistake. I would avoid blaming individuals unnecessarily and focus on preventing similar problems in the future."

48. What does discipline mean to you?

Sample answer:

"Discipline means maintaining consistency in our actions, following rules, respecting commitments and completing responsibilities even when motivation is low."

49. Would you sacrifice your personal comfort for your team?

Sample answer:

"Yes, when the situation demands it. Team objectives sometimes require individuals to make personal adjustments. However, such decisions should be guided by responsibility, practicality and the overall mission."

50. What makes you suitable for becoming an officer?

Sample answer:

"I believe my willingness to learn, sense of responsibility, interest in teamwork and ability to accept challenges provide a foundation for becoming an officer. I also understand that I have areas to improve, and I am prepared to work consistently towards developing the required qualities."

SET 3: Defence Knowledge, NDA, Armed Forces and General Awareness (25 Questions)

These questions test your awareness of the Indian Armed Forces, NDA, military leadership, defence structure and national security.

51. What is NDA?

Sample answer:

"NDA stands for National Defence Academy. It is a joint services training institution located in Khadakwasla, near Pune, Maharashtra. It provides training to cadets of the Indian Army, Navy and Air Force before they proceed to their respective pre-commissioning training academies."

52. Where is the National Defence Academy located?

Sample answer:

"The National Defence Academy is located at Khadakwasla, approximately 17 kilometres from Pune city in Maharashtra."

53. Why was NDA established?

Sample answer:

"NDA was established to provide joint training to future officers of the three services. Its objective is to develop leadership, discipline, camaraderie and an understanding of joint military operations."

54. What are the three branches of the Indian Armed Forces?

Sample answer:

"The three branches are:

1. Indian Army
2. Indian Navy
3. Indian Air Force."

55. Who is the Supreme Commander of the Indian Armed Forces?

Sample answer:

"The President of India is the Supreme Commander of the Indian Armed Forces."

56. Who is the current Chief of Defence Staff (CDS) of India?

Sample answer:

"Sir, the Chief of Defence Staff is the senior-most military adviser to the Government of India on matters concerning the armed forces and promotes jointness among the three services."

Preparation note: Memorise the current officeholder's name before your interview. This is a time-sensitive question.

57. Who is the Chief of the Indian Army?

Sample answer:

"The Chief of the Army Staff is the professional head of the Indian Army."

Preparation note: Learn the current Army Chief's name and appointment date.

58. Who is the Chief of the Indian Navy?

Sample answer:

"The Chief of the Naval Staff is the professional head of the Indian Navy."

Preparation note: Learn the current Navy Chief's name.

59. Who is the Chief of the Indian Air Force?

Sample answer:

"The Chief of the Air Staff is the professional head of the Indian Air Force."

Preparation note: Learn the current Air Chief's name.

60. What is the difference between NDA and CDS examinations?

Sample answer:

"The NDA examination is conducted by UPSC for candidates who have completed or are appearing in Class 12, subject to eligibility requirements.

The CDS examination is conducted for graduates seeking entry into the Indian Military Academy, Indian Naval Academy, Air Force Academy and Officers Training Academy, subject to the respective eligibility criteria."

61. What is the difference between the Army, Navy and Air Force?

Sample answer:

- **Indian Army:** Primarily responsible for land-based military operations.
- **Indian Navy:** Primarily responsible for maritime security and naval operations.
- **Indian Air Force:** Primarily responsible for air defence and air operations.

All three services work together to protect India's sovereignty and national interests.

62. What are the ranks in the Indian Army?

Sample answer:

"Some of the commissioned officer ranks in ascending order are:

1. Lieutenant
2. Captain
3. Major
4. Lieutenant Colonel
5. Colonel
6. Brigadier
7. Major General
8. Lieutenant General
9. General."

63. What is the role of the Indian Army?

Sample answer:

"The Indian Army protects the country's land borders, safeguards territorial integrity, conducts military operations and assists civil authorities during emergencies and natural disasters when required."

64. What is the role of the Indian Navy?

Sample answer:

"The Indian Navy protects India's maritime interests, secures sea routes, conducts maritime operations and contributes to regional maritime security."

65. What is the role of the Indian Air Force?

Sample answer:

"The Indian Air Force protects Indian airspace, conducts air operations, provides air support to other services and undertakes humanitarian assistance and disaster relief operations."

66. What is the difference between a commissioned officer and a non-commissioned officer?

Sample answer:

"A commissioned officer holds a commission granted by the President of India and performs leadership, command and management responsibilities. Non-commissioned officers are personnel who hold leadership ranks within the other ranks structure and supervise personnel and operational activities."

67. What is the motto of the National Defence Academy?

Sample answer:

"The motto of NDA is 'Seva Parmo Dharma', meaning 'Service Before Self'."

68. What is the motto of the Indian Army?

Sample answer:

"The motto of the Indian Army is 'Service Before Self'."

69. What is the motto of the Indian Navy?

Sample answer:

"The motto of the Indian Navy is 'Sham No Varunah', meaning 'May the Lord of the Water be auspicious unto us'."

70. What is the motto of the Indian Air Force?

Sample answer:

"The motto of the Indian Air Force is 'Nabha Sparsham Deeptam', meaning 'Touch the Sky with Glory'."

71. Name some important military operations conducted by India.

Sample answer:

"Some important military operations and campaigns include:

- Operation Vijay (1999): Associated with the Kargil War.
- Operation Meghdoot (1984): Securing the Siachen Glacier.

- Operation Cactus (1988): India's military intervention in the Maldives following an attempted coup.
- Operation Pawan (1987): Indian Peace Keeping Force operations in Sri Lanka."

72. What is the difference between a fighter aircraft, transport aircraft and helicopter?

Sample answer:

- **Fighter aircraft:** Designed primarily for air combat and defence missions.
- **Transport aircraft:** Used for transporting personnel, equipment and supplies.
- **Helicopters:** Used for transport, reconnaissance, rescue, medical evacuation and other military operations.

73. Name five important aircraft used by the Indian Air Force.

Sample answer:

"Some important aircraft include:

1. Rafale
2. Sukhoi Su-30MKI
3. Tejas
4. Mirage 2000
5. C-17 Globemaster III."

74. What is the difference between a submarine and a warship?

Sample answer:

"A submarine is a naval vessel designed to operate underwater, whereas a warship generally operates on the surface of the water. Both perform different roles in naval operations and maritime security."

75. Why is discipline important in the Armed Forces?

Sample answer:

"Discipline ensures coordination, reliability, accountability and effective execution of responsibilities. In military environments, personnel must work together under challenging conditions, making discipline essential for operational effectiveness."

SET 4: Situational, Analytical, Current Affairs and Advanced Personal Interview Questions (25 Questions)

These questions test your ability to think independently, analyse situations, express opinions and demonstrate maturity.

76. What would you do if you were stranded in an unfamiliar place without a mobile phone?

Sample answer:

"I would remain calm, assess my surroundings and identify nearby landmarks or public places. I would approach a trustworthy local authority or responsible individual for assistance and try to identify a safe route to my destination."

77. Suppose you are leading a group and one member refuses to cooperate. What would you do?

Sample answer:

"I would speak to the individual privately and understand the reason for the lack of cooperation. I would explain the importance of the common objective and try to assign responsibilities according to individual capabilities. If the issue continued, I would address it through the appropriate authority."

78. If you are given a task that seems impossible, what will you do?

Sample answer:

"I would first understand the objective and available resources. I would divide the task into smaller activities, identify possible solutions and seek assistance where necessary. I would make a sincere effort rather than rejecting the task immediately."

79. If you are selected for the Army but wanted the Air Force, what would you do?

Sample answer:

"Sir, I would respect the selection process and the opportunity offered to me. My primary objective is to serve as an officer in the Armed Forces. I would carefully consider the service offered and make a decision based on my eligibility, aptitude and genuine interest."

80. What would you do if you were not recommended by the SSB?

Sample answer:

"I would accept the result positively, analyse my performance and identify areas requiring improvement. I would continue developing my personality and prepare for another opportunity if I remained eligible. I would not allow one unsuccessful attempt to define my capabilities."

81. What is patriotism according to you?

Sample answer:

"Patriotism means respecting the country, its Constitution, its people and its values. It also means fulfilling our responsibilities honestly, contributing to society and working towards the nation's progress."

82. What is the biggest challenge facing India's youth?

Sample answer:

"I believe some important challenges include unemployment, unequal access to quality education, skill gaps, mental health concerns and the responsible use of technology. Addressing these issues requires education, skill development, innovation and opportunities for young people."

83. What are the major security challenges for India?

Sample answer:

"India faces several security challenges, including border security concerns, terrorism, cyber threats, maritime security challenges, misinformation and regional geopolitical tensions. Addressing these requires strong defence capabilities, intelligence coordination, diplomacy and technological development."

84. What is the importance of technology in modern warfare?

Sample answer:

"Technology plays an important role in communication, surveillance, intelligence, logistics, air defence and decision-making. Modern armed forces increasingly depend on advanced technologies such as artificial intelligence, drones, satellites and cybersecurity systems."

85. What is your opinion about women joining the Armed Forces?

Sample answer:

"I believe opportunities should be based on merit, eligibility and the requirements of the service. Women have demonstrated their capabilities in various military roles, and providing suitable opportunities strengthens the talent pool of the Armed Forces."

86. What is the importance of physical fitness for an officer?

Sample answer:

"Physical fitness helps an officer maintain endurance, strength, agility and the ability to perform duties under demanding conditions. It also contributes to mental resilience and sets a positive example for the team."

87. What would you do if you noticed a fellow cadet breaking an important rule?

Sample answer:

"I would first understand the situation and explain why following the rule is important. If the violation was serious or continued, I would inform the appropriate authority rather than ignoring it."

88. If you could change one thing in your school, what would it be?

Sample answer:

"I would introduce more practical learning opportunities, sports activities and leadership-based projects. These activities can help students develop communication, teamwork and problem-solving skills alongside academics."

89. What is the difference between success and happiness?

Sample answer:

"Success generally relates to achieving goals, while happiness is a broader feeling of satisfaction and well-being. I believe meaningful success should also contribute to personal growth, relationships and a sense of purpose."

90. Do you believe a leader should be strict or friendly?

Sample answer:

"A leader should maintain a balance. A leader must be approachable and understand the team, but should also be firm when responsibilities, discipline and standards are involved."

91. What would you do if you had to choose between saving time and following the correct procedure?

Sample answer:

"I would consider the urgency and nature of the situation. I would not compromise safety or legal requirements merely to save time. In an emergency, I would act within established emergency procedures and use the available resources efficiently."

92. What is your opinion about social media?

Sample answer:

"Social media is a useful platform for communication, education and information sharing. However, excessive use, misinformation and privacy concerns are significant challenges. I believe it should be used responsibly and in a balanced manner."

93. Who is your role model and why?

Sample answer:

"My role model is [Name]. I admire this person because of [specific qualities or achievements]. I try to learn from their discipline, determination and approach to responsibilities."

You can choose a military personality, sportsperson, scientist, teacher or someone from your family.

94. If you could meet any military officer, whom would you meet and why?

Sample answer:

"I would like to meet Field Marshal Sam Manekshaw. I admire his leadership, professional competence, confidence and contribution to India's military history. I would be interested in understanding his approach to leadership and decision-making."

95. What do you know about the Kargil War?

Sample answer:

"The Kargil War took place in 1999 between India and Pakistan in the Kargil sector of Jammu and Kashmir. Indian forces conducted Operation Vijay to recapture positions occupied by Pakistani forces and infiltrators. The conflict ended with India regaining the occupied positions. Kargil Vijay Diwas is observed on 26 July every year."

96. What is the difference between internal security and external security?

Sample answer:

"Internal security concerns threats within the country, such as terrorism, organised crime, insurgency and communal violence. External security concerns threats originating outside the country's borders, including military aggression and cross-border threats."

97. What would you do if your team failed despite your best efforts?

Sample answer:

"I would take responsibility for my contribution, analyse the reasons for failure and discuss improvements with the team. I would identify what could have been done differently and apply those lessons to future tasks."

98. Where do you see yourself 10 years from now?

Sample answer:

"I see myself as a professionally competent and responsible officer who has developed strong leadership abilities, gained valuable experience and contributed meaningfully to the organisation. I would also like to continue learning and improving throughout my career."

99. Why should the SSB recommend you?

Sample answer:

"Sir, I understand that selection depends on demonstrating the required qualities rather than simply claiming to possess them. I believe I have a foundation of responsibility, willingness to learn, teamwork and determination. I am aware of my shortcomings and continuously work towards improving myself. I would be grateful for the opportunity to prove my capabilities through my actions."

100. Do you have any questions for me?

Sample answer:

"Yes, Sir. I would like to know what qualities and professional habits you believe a young officer should continuously develop throughout their military career."

This shows curiosity and an interest in professional development.

How to prepare these 100 questions effectively

I recommend dividing your preparation into four stages.

Preparation stage	Questions	Focus
Stage 1	1–25	Know yourself and your family
Stage 2	26–50	Develop personality and leadership
Stage 3	51–75	Understand NDA and Armed Forces
Stage 4	76–100	Improve decision-making and awareness

Five golden rules for your SSB personal interview

1. **Never memorise answers word for word.** Understand the idea and answer naturally.
2. **Be truthful.** The interviewing officer may ask several follow-up questions based on one answer.
3. **Know your Personal Information Questionnaire (PIQ) thoroughly.** Your family, friends, education, achievements and hobbies are important discussion areas.
4. **Be specific.** Give real examples instead of making general statements about your personality.
5. **Maintain composure.** If you don't know an answer, politely admit it rather than guessing.

One important point: These are practice questions, not an official or guaranteed list of SSB interview questions. The actual interview is conversational, and the interviewing officer may explore your answers in considerable depth.